

Chapter 96-3

Liang Shi said helplessly, "Who else could it be?"

"Sheng Yu?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi nodded. "Yeah. She even has a little tiger tooth—did you notice?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu was about to go settle accounts with Sheng Yu, but Liang Shi stopped her, saying she had been bitten because she lost a bet to Sheng Yu.

After Sheng Yu bit her, she even felt embarrassed about it and rubbed the spot for her for a long time.

The bite mark would fade in another two hours—it didn't hurt at all.

Xu Qingzhu still went to the living room anyway. She sat down next to Sheng Yu and directly snatched the snacks from her hands.

Sheng Yu looked at her innocently, blinking. "What? Is it time to eat?"

"Time to eat people." Xu Qingzhu asked her. "Why do you like biting people?"

Sheng Yu: "....."

She huffed coldly. "Sister Liang has no martial ethics¹—she actually tattled!"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"She lost a bet to me." Sheng Yu tattled back. "A bet is a bet. If I had lost, she would have bitten me too."

Xu Qingzhu asked her, "What did you two bet on?"

Sheng Yu pressed her lips together and stayed silent.

Ling Dang suddenly came over and raised her hand. "I know!"

Sheng Yu's eyes widened. She lunged forward to cover Ling Dang's mouth and threatened, "Liang Wenxuan, don't you dare say it!"

When it was almost time to eat, Xu Qingzhu took everyone to wash their hands. Taking advantage of the moment, she quietly asked Ling Dang, "What did they bet on?"

Ling Dang leaned close to her ear and said, "They bet on how many seeds were in a bag of sunflower seeds."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

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Wrapping dumplings was quite troublesome, but Liang Shi's hands were fast, and Su Yao also knew a bit. Only Xu Qingzhu was a beginner.

Yet Xu Qingzhu was the calmest of them all. Although the dumplings she wrapped could only be pinched shut at the top with no shape whatsoever, the confident expression on her face made people feel like the dumplings she made were the most beautiful dumplings in the whole world.

By the time they sat down to eat, it was already 8:30 PM.

The three children happened to not be hungry either. They had eaten ice cream cones after school, and then had snacks when they came back in the evening. Sitting on the sofa huddled together watching TV with great enjoyment, not a single one of them said they were hungry.

Liang Shi still brought the three of them to eat.

Rainbow didn't need anyone to look after her—she even took the initiative to help get the tableware. The other two were already sitting at the table discussing how many dumplings they were going to eat.

Sheng Yu said she wasn't hungry, so she would only eat three.

Ling Dang said she wasn't hungry either, but she would eat one more than Sheng Yu.

Within two minutes, their competitive spirits had escalated to the point where each of them was going to eat ten dumplings.

Then Sheng Yu proudly asked Xu Qingzhu, "Sister, do you think it's good if I eat ten dumplings?"

Xu Qingzhu's voice was cool and her face expressionless. "You'll burst."

Sheng Yu: "....."

Ling Dang happily ate her meal.

Su Yao had already given Su Zhe a heads-up earlier that she would be staying at Xu Qingzhu's place with Sheng Yu for the night.

During dinner, Rainbow made a video call to Zhou Li. Sheng Yu and Ling Dang acted cute through the video. "Hello, Auntie."

Liang Shi chatted with Zhou Li for a bit, and things finally settled down.

This was the first time this home had so many people in it—it felt alive with warmth.

Dusk had fallen on all sides, brilliant stars scattered across the firmament. Outside, lights glittered as streams of cars shuttled back and forth through the city. In this moment, the lights of countless homes seemed to converge at this small dining table.

Warm steam dispersed throughout the house, and the children's smiling faces were especially lovely.

Liang Shi had been busy for a long time and wasn't very hungry, but watching others eat gave her a sense of happiness.

While everyone was busy eating, Xu Qingzhu placed two dumplings in her bowl without saying a word, then lowered her head to continue eating.

The house didn't have many rooms, but the living room sofa was a fold-out—when unfolded, it became a bed.

Liang Shi's arrangement was to have Su Yao and Xu Qingzhu sleep in the master bedroom, the three children squeeze into the second bedroom, and she herself would sleep on the sofa.

The conditions were indeed a bit simple, but the three children had no objections.

Su Yao, however, said she could sleep on the sofa and let Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu share a room.

Liang Shi said helplessly, "You should stay with Zhuzi. You haven't seen each other in so many years—you can chat before bed."

Xu Qingzhu only hesitated for a moment before joining her in persuading Su Yao to sleep with her.

Fortunately, the bed in the second bedroom was big enough that having three children sleep in it wouldn't risk them falling off.

But even if they did fall off, it would be fine—Liang Shi had laid a soft, fluffy carpet beside the bed.

Footnotes:

¹ **No martial ethics (不講武德):** A popular Chinese internet meme originating from a video where an elderly martial arts master accused a younger opponent of having "no martial ethics" (meaning no sense of fair play or sportsmanship). It's now used humorously to accuse someone of being unfair or playing dirty, often in trivial situations.